



◁ **Tiger**
Date 1942 **Country** Germany
Weight 63.8 tons (57.9 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL210P45 gasoline, 650 hp (see p.75)
Main armament 8.8 cm KwK 36 L/56 gun

The Tiger was the product of Germany's experience of fighting in France in 1940. Heavily armored and armed with the powerful 8.8 cm gun, it proved a formidable opponent for Allied tank crews. However, the Tiger was not only expensive; its mechanical complexity also made it prone to technical problems. Only 1,347 were built.

7.5 cm main gun



◁ **Panther**
Date 1943 **Country** Germany
Weight 51 tons (46.2 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL230P30 gasoline, 700 hp
Main armament 7.5 cm KwK 42 L/70 gun

Designed in response to the Soviet T-34, the Panther was more heavily armored and boasted far greater firepower. First used at Kursk in July 1943, it was fast and maneuverable, with strong frontal armor, and a very accurate and powerful gun. However, like the Tiger, it was often unreliable; engine fires were common.



Armor sloped variably between 25 and 50 degrees



▷ **Tiger II (King Tiger)**
Date 1944 **Country** Germany
Weight 76.2 tons (69.1 tonnes)
Engine Maybach HL230P30 gasoline, 700 hp
Main armament 8.8 cm KwK 43 L/71

The Tiger II was perhaps the most formidable tank of World War II. Its frontal armor could withstand all Allied anti-tank weapons, and its 8.8 cm gun was a threat even at long range. Its engine was unreliable, however, and only 489 were built—too few to influence the outcome of the war.